Pacific Command: Ship Reference Photos

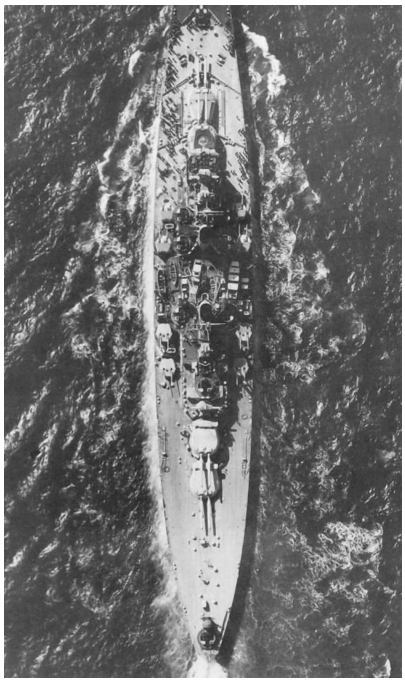
Collected 28 October 2026. One section per ship class, with each photo, what to draw from it, and what to change so the ship looks right for 1941-45. These photos are references for drawing original game art; they are not used in the game itself.

For a new chat: attach this PDF and say "These are the reference photos for my Pacific Command game. Read my Pacific Command Design Document (including the Ship references tab) and use these to draw each class top-down."

Open questions: (1) The prewar light-gray cruiser photo was sent under both Brooklyn and New Orleans; which ship is it? (2) Captions for the two Kaga/Akagi-section photos. (3) Still wanted: a 1941-45 Nagato, full-size Kongo and Fuso plans, a Brooklyn top view, Soryu, a wartime Independence-class view.

Style reference

Draw from these: The overhead battleship photo that set the game's look: camera straight down, whole ship visible, foam along the hull.



The original top-down reference photo

US Navy

North Carolina class (battleship)

Draw from these: Two triple 16-inch turrets forward, the second raised; tower foremast; two close funnels; 5-inch twins stepped along the superstructure; crane and floatplanes aft; strong bow wave and side wash.

For 1941-45: No changes needed.



USS Washington, 19-N-33803, off New York, August 1942



USS North Carolina, NH 80988, off the US east coast, April 1942

South Dakota class (battleship)

Draw from these: Shorter hull, single funnel faired into the tower, two 40mm quad tubs on the fantail. Harbor net and tender usable as scenery.

For 1941-45: No changes needed.



USS Massachusetts, NH 97254, entering Boston harbor, May 1942

Iowa class (battleship)

Draw from these: Teak deck, haze gray hull, deep blue sea; turret and barrel shapes; bow wave.

For 1941-45: Replace 1980s missiles, close-in guns, helipad and lattice mast with 40mm and 20mm guns, catapults and Kingfishers, wartime tower mast and SK/SG radars.



USS Wisconsin (BB-64), 1980s

Older battleship: USS Texas (New York class)

Draw from these: Five twin 14-inch turrets, tripod masts, single funnel, casemate guns in the hull sides, anti-torpedo bulges. Fought at Iwo Jima and Okinawa, 1945.

For 1941-45: Colors from the model, layout from the drone shot (museum ship is in restoration paint).



USS Texas (BB-35), scale model in wartime paint



USS Texas museum ship, drone view

Yorktown class (fleet carrier)

Draw from these: Deck markings (dashed white lines, large hull number), folded-wing deck park aft, crew on deck, catwalks and gun tubs, starboard island with single funnel.

For 1941-45: Measure 21 dark paint for wartime.



USS Enterprise (CV-6), looking aft from above the bow



USS Enterprise (CV-6) underway, high oblique



USS Yorktown (CV-5), about 1937, prewar light gray

Essex class (fleet carrier)

Draw from these: Full 1943 deck park (Dauntless, Avengers, Hellcats), open bow, stern 40mm quads, starboard island.

For 1941-45: Use the 1943 photo. Ignore CV-10's angled deck, hurricane bow and postwar aircraft.



USS Essex, 80-G-68097, underway, May 1943



USS Yorktown (CV-10), postwar

Independence class (light carrier)

Draw from these: Narrow deck on a cruiser hull, small starboard island, gun tubs and catwalks.

For 1941-45: Restore the four small angled funnels on the starboard side, wartime mast, Measure 33 dazzle.



USS Bataan (CVL-29), thumbnail, dazzle camouflage



USS Bataan, thumbnail, near overhead



USS Bataan, about 1950

Casablanca class (escort carrier)

Draw from these: Short square deck, big hull number forward, small island at the edge, Avengers and Wildcats, dazzle camouflage.

For 1941-45: No changes needed.



Casablanca-class escort carrier, aerial

Cleveland class (light cruiser)

Draw from these: Two triple 6-inch turrets forward, twin 5-inch stepped up the superstructure, two upright funnels, Kingfishers on stern catapults with crane.

For 1941-45: No changes needed.



Cleveland-class cruiser, high angle, dark wartime paint



Cleveland-class cruiser, light gray, side view

Atlanta class (anti-aircraft cruiser)

Draw from these: Twin 5-inch mounts stacked three fore and three aft plus beam mounts, two thin funnels, no aircraft.

For 1941-45: Wartime paint.



Atlanta-class cruiser, light gray, aerial

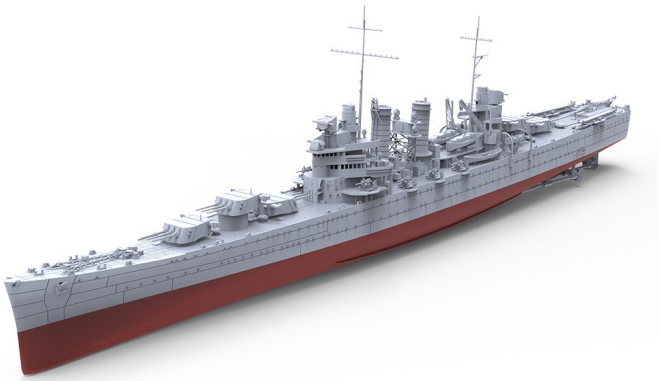
Brooklyn class (light cruiser)

Draw from these: Two close funnels, two masts, high square stern hangar. Real Brooklyn: five triple 6-inch turrets, three forward and two aft.

For 1941-45: Top view or deck plan still wanted.



Prewar light-gray cruiser (also sent under New Orleans; which ship is open)

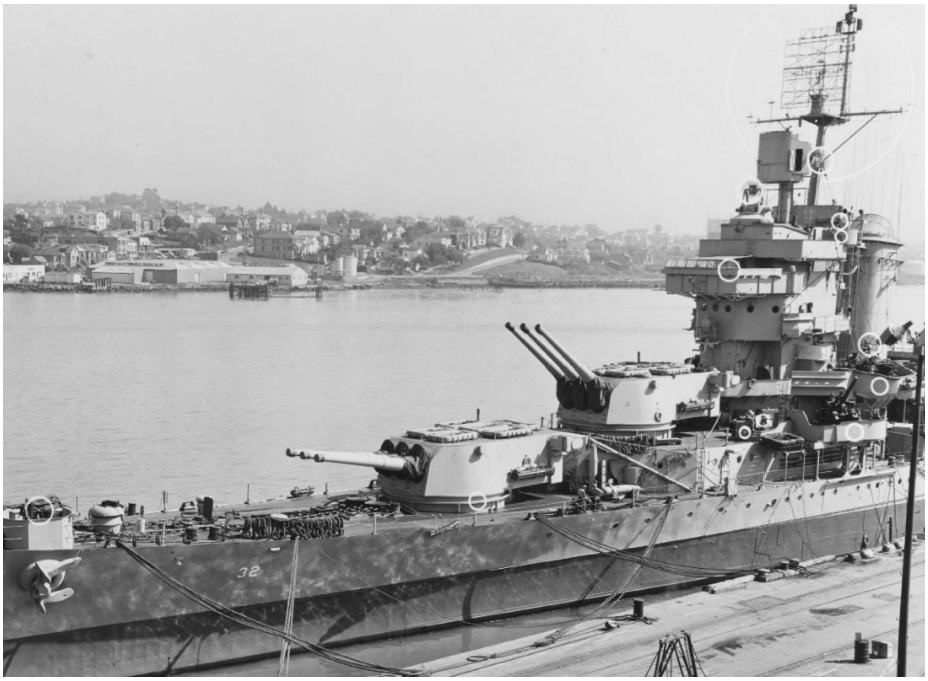


3D render (may be a different class; shows only two forward turrets)

New Orleans class (heavy cruiser)

Draw from these: Two triple 8-inch turrets forward, life rafts on turret roofs, tall bridge with air-search radar, forecastle gear, weathered hull.

For 1941-45: No changes needed.



USS New Orleans (CA-32), wartime shipyard photo

Baltimore class (heavy cruiser)

Draw from these: Two triple 8-inch forward, two raked funnels, twin stern cranes and floatplanes.

For 1941-45: Measure 32 is a good optional skin.



Baltimore-class cruiser, broadside profile



USS Baltimore (CA-68) in Measure 32 dazzle

Fletcher class (destroyer)

Draw from these: Five 5-inch gunhouses, two funnels, torpedo mounts amidships, curling turn wake.

For 1941-45: Use DD-445's wartime fit; on DD-631 restore pole mast and both torpedo mounts.



USS Fletcher (DD-445), Measure 31 camouflage, wartime



USS Erben (DD-631), color, postwar

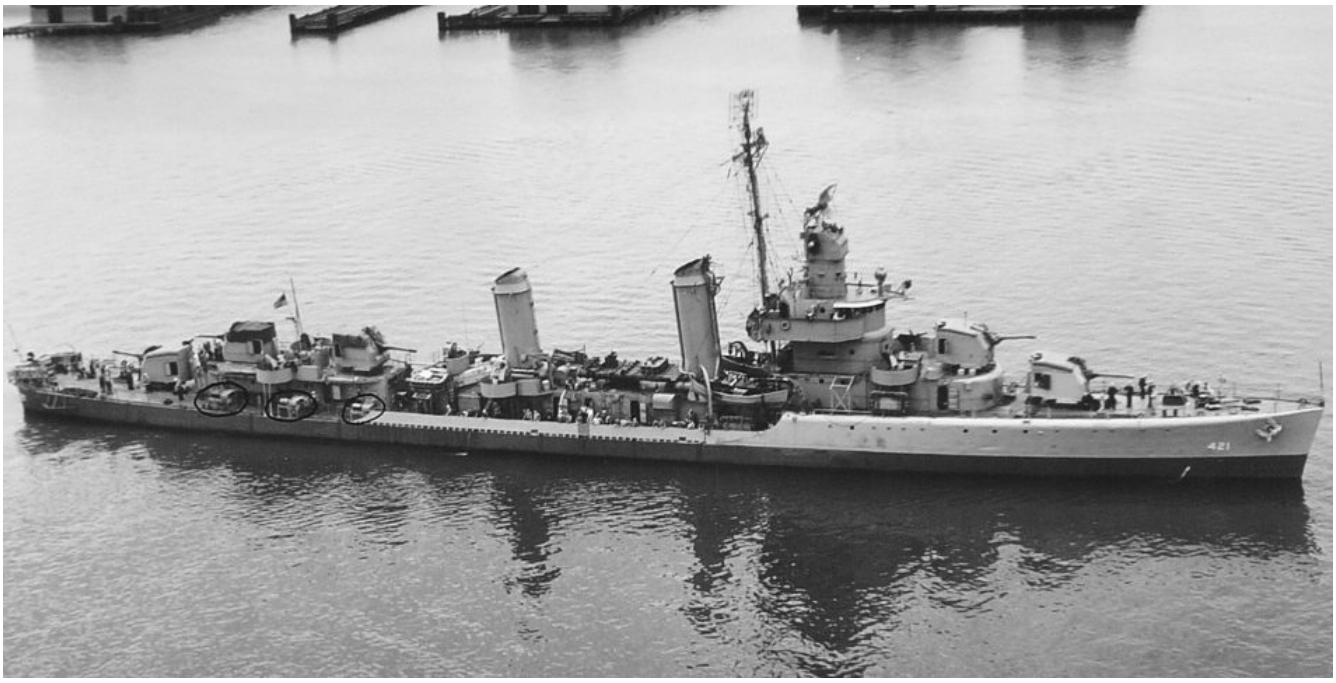
Benson / Gleaves class (destroyer)

Draw from these: Flat-sided funnels (Benson) vs round (Gleaves); 1943 fit with one torpedo mount.

For 1941-45: No changes needed.



USS Meade (DD-602), Measure 12 modified, 1942



USS Benson (DD-421), high angle at a pier

Allen M. Sumner class (destroyer)

Draw from these: Clear-day bright blue sea, spray and bow wave, twin 5-inch mounts.

For 1941-45: Restore pole mast, torpedo tubes, 40mm quads and twins.



USS Allen M. Sumner (DD-692), color, postwar



USS Lyman K. Swenson (DD-729), color, postwar

Buckley class (destroyer escort)

Draw from these: Flush hull, one funnel, 3-inch guns fore and aft, hedgehog, triple torpedo tubes, depth-charge racks and K-guns.

For 1941-45: No changes needed.



Buckley class, near-overhead aerial



USS Buckley (DE-51), side view



USS Buckley (DE-51), high oblique

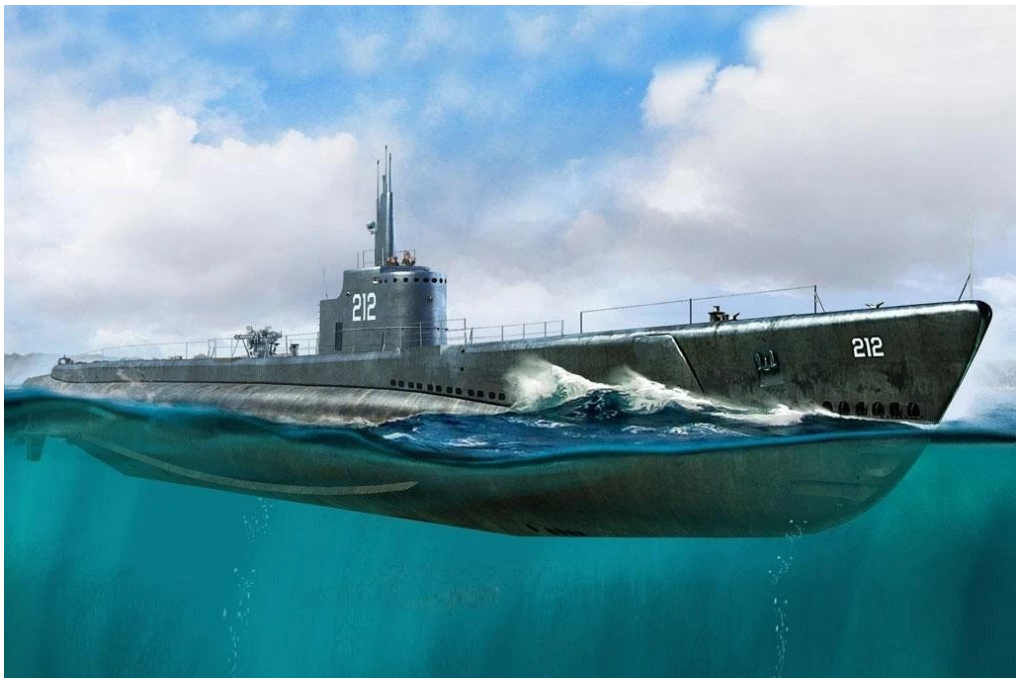
Gato class (submarine)

Draw from these: Late-war cut-down conning tower, two-tone paint; surfaced subs sit with the deck awash and hull faint under clear water.

For 1941-45: Early-war full fairwater for 1942 boats.



USS Gato (SS-212), Mare Island, 29 November 1944

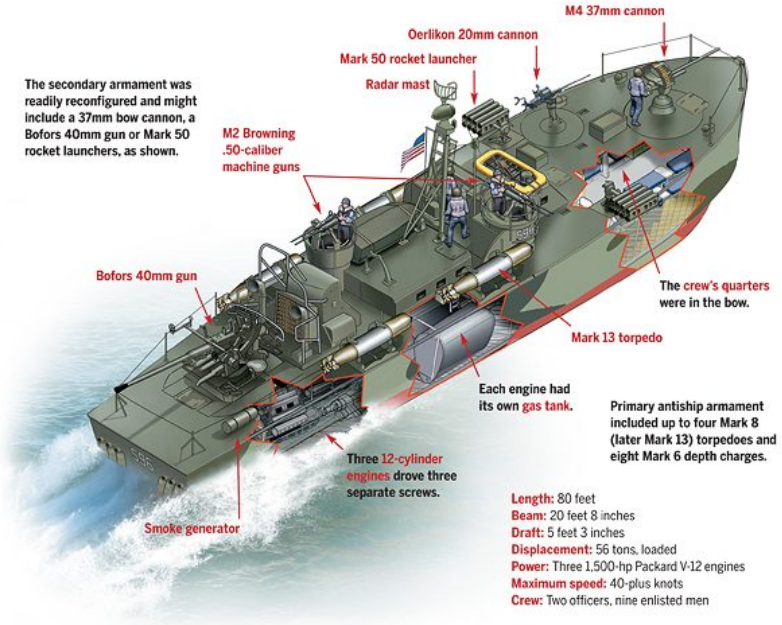


USS Gato artwork, surfaced

Elco 80-ft PT boat

Draw from these: Modules: four Mark 13 torpedoes, twin .50s, 37mm, 20mm, 40mm, rockets, radar, smoke generator, three engines each with its own gas tank. Crew 11. Bow-up planing with a rooster-tail wake.

For 1941-45: Gas tanks are a fire-hazard module.



Elco PT boat cutaway illustration



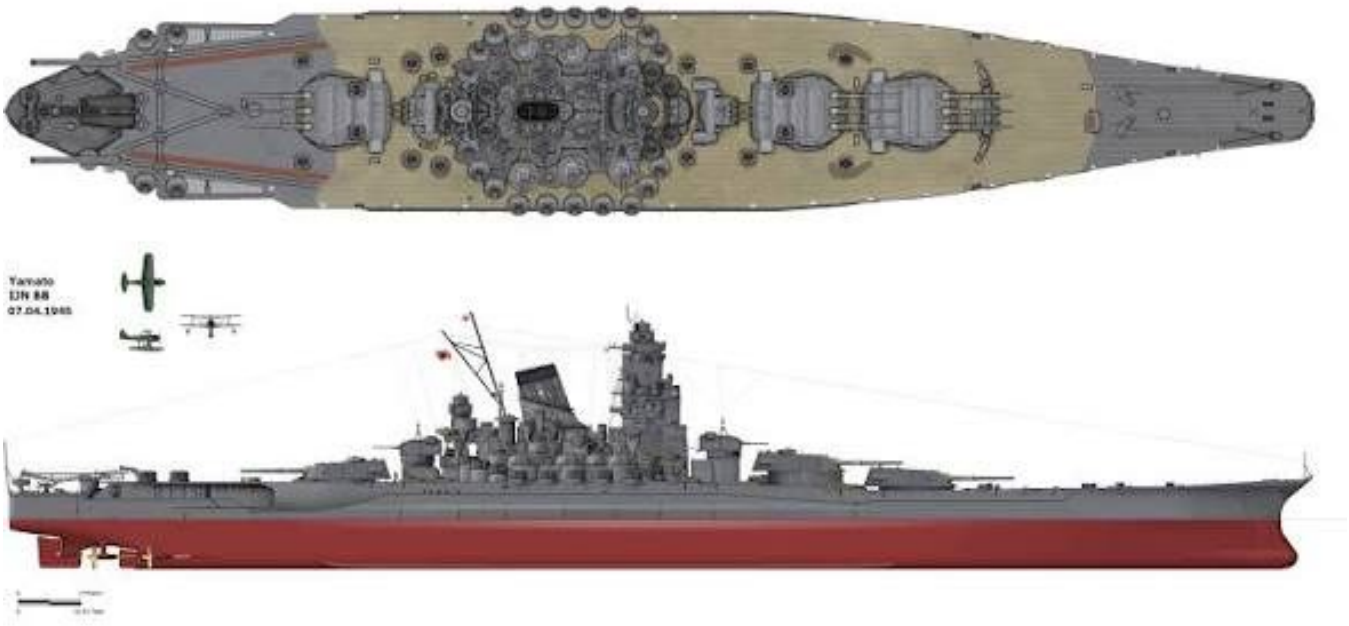
PT boats at speed

Imperial Japanese Navy

Yamato class (battleship)

Draw from these: Exact top view: wood deck, three main turrets, massive late-war 25mm AA cluster, catapults aft.

For 1941-45: 1945 plan for late war, trials photo for 1941-43.



Yamato plan and profile, 7 April 1945

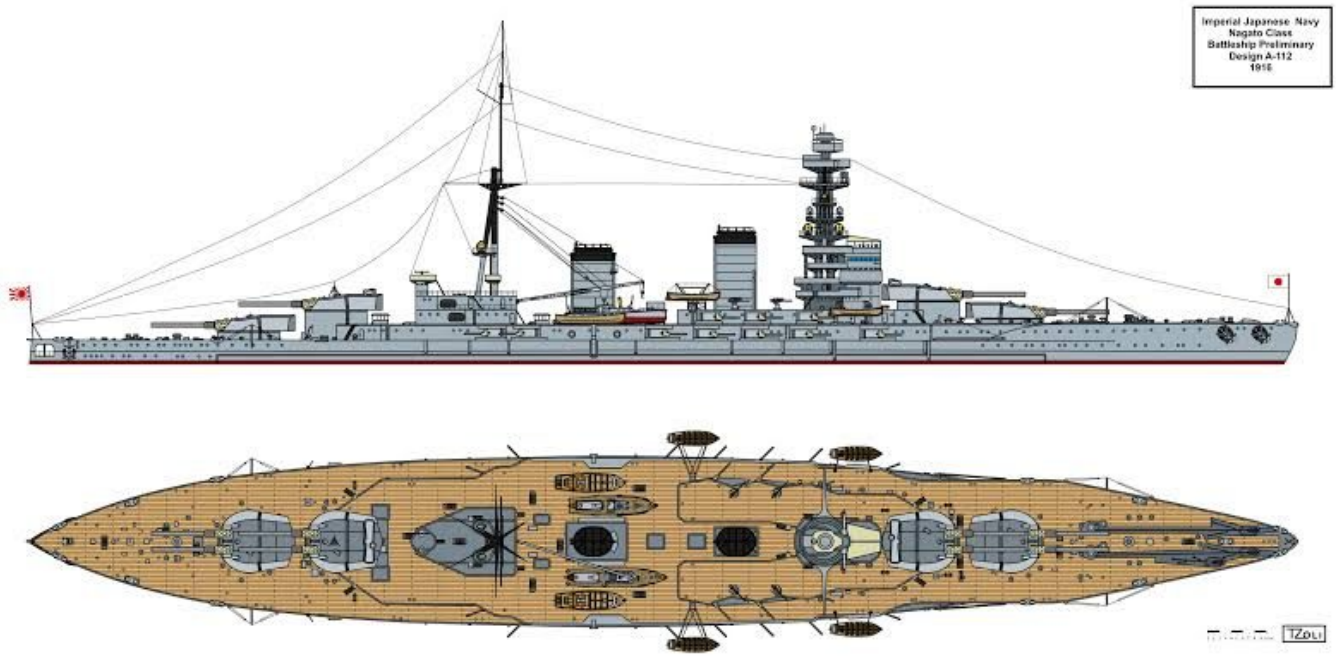


Yamato on trials, 1941

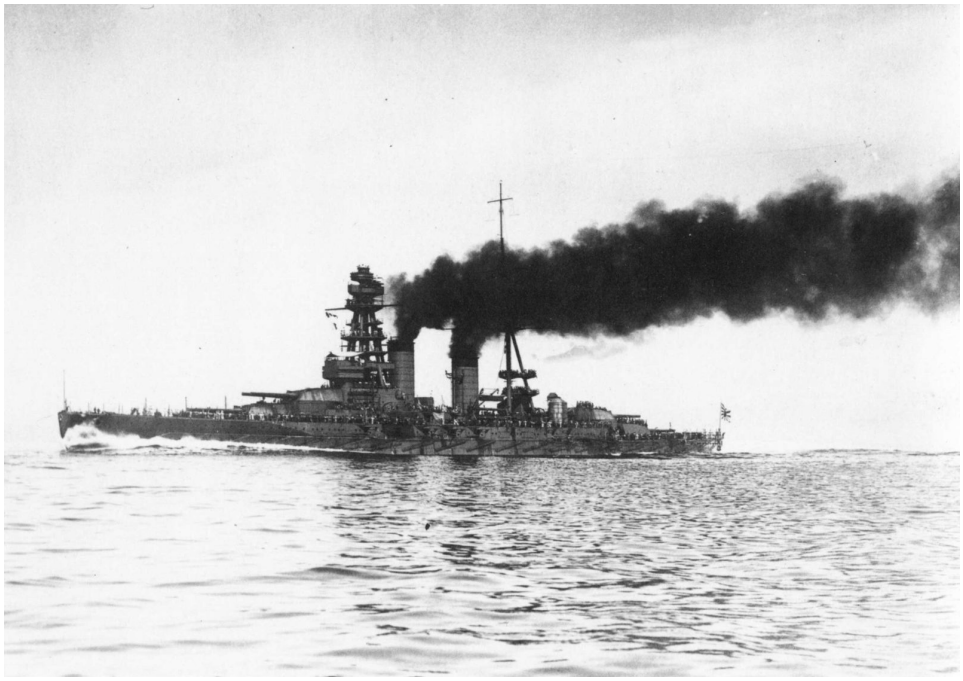
Nagato class (battleship)

Draw from these: Deck plan style; heavy black funnel smoke.

For 1941-45: Both prewar. Rebuilt 1934-36 with one funnel, pagoda, bulges, catapult. Wartime reference still wanted.



Nagato preliminary design A-112, 1916 (not as built)



Nagato as completed, about 1920

Fuso class (battleship)

Draw from these: Very tall pagoda, single funnel, six twin turrets spread along the ship.

For 1941-45: Use Kure gray, not the colorized tones. Full-size plan wanted.



Fuso plan and profile (thumbnail)

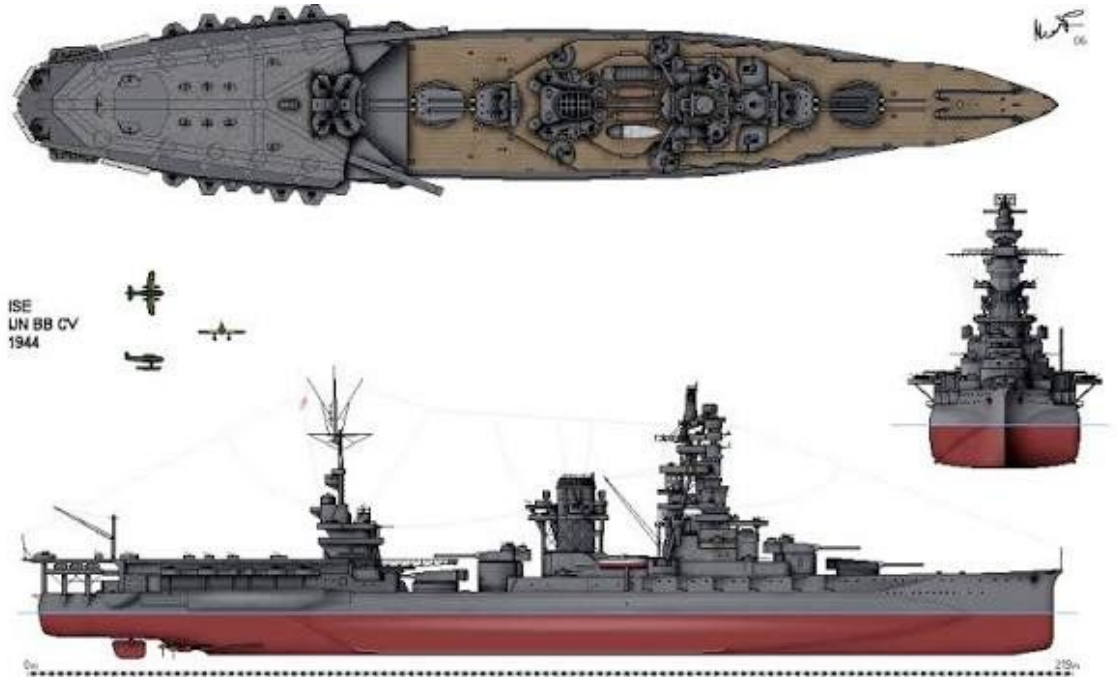


Fuso at speed, colorized

Ise class (hybrid battleship-carrier)

Draw from these: Forward four turrets, pagoda, aft flight deck with rails and AA.

For 1941-45: A 1983 US 'battlecarrier' drawing sent with these is a different ship and is left out.



Ise plan and profile, 1944



Ise or Hyuga at speed, colorized

Kongo class (battleship), includes Kirishima

Draw from these: Four twin 35.6 cm turrets, pagoda, two funnels.

For 1941-45: Use the 1944 drawing; the 1913 photo only for smoke and wake. Full-size plan wanted.



Kongo plan and profile, 1944 (thumbnail)



Kongo as built, about 1913

Kaga and Akagi (fleet carriers)

Draw from these: Wood decks, white markings, hinomaru forward. Kaga's island on the starboard side, Akagi's on the port side amidships.

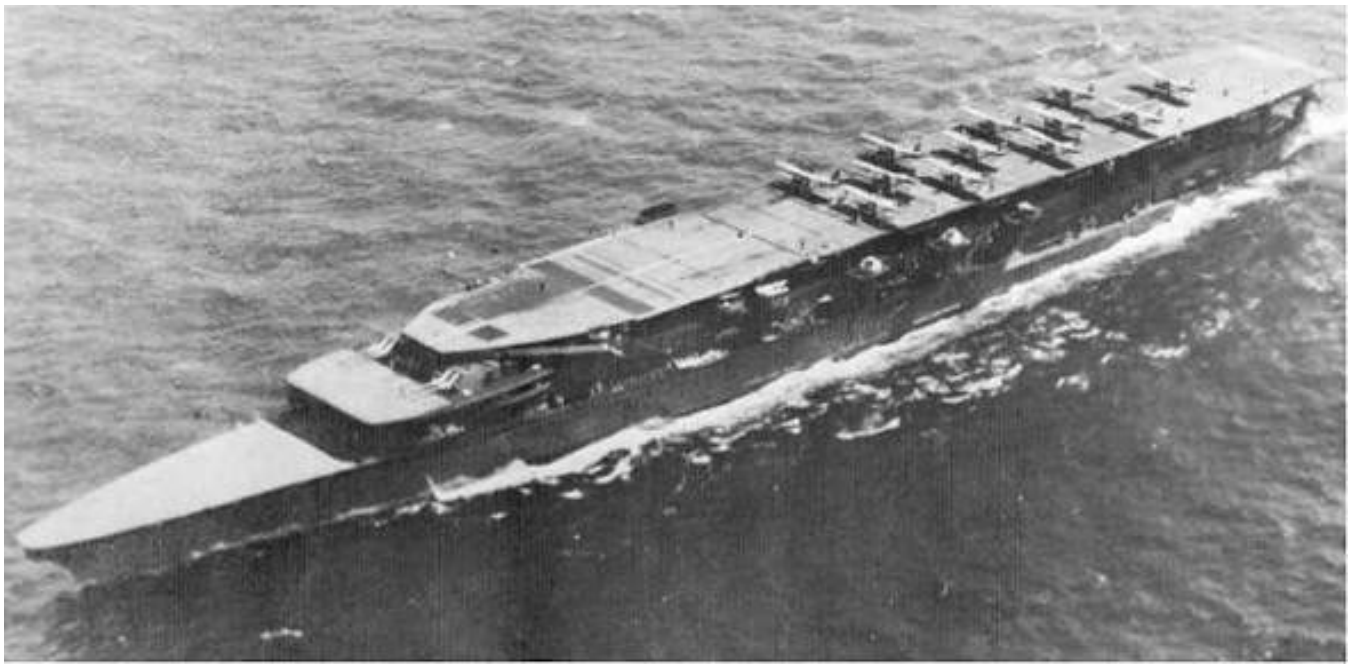
For 1941-45: Captions wanted for the two photos.



Render: Kaga (top) and Akagi (bottom)



Carrier seen from a landing aircraft (island to starboard; caption needed)

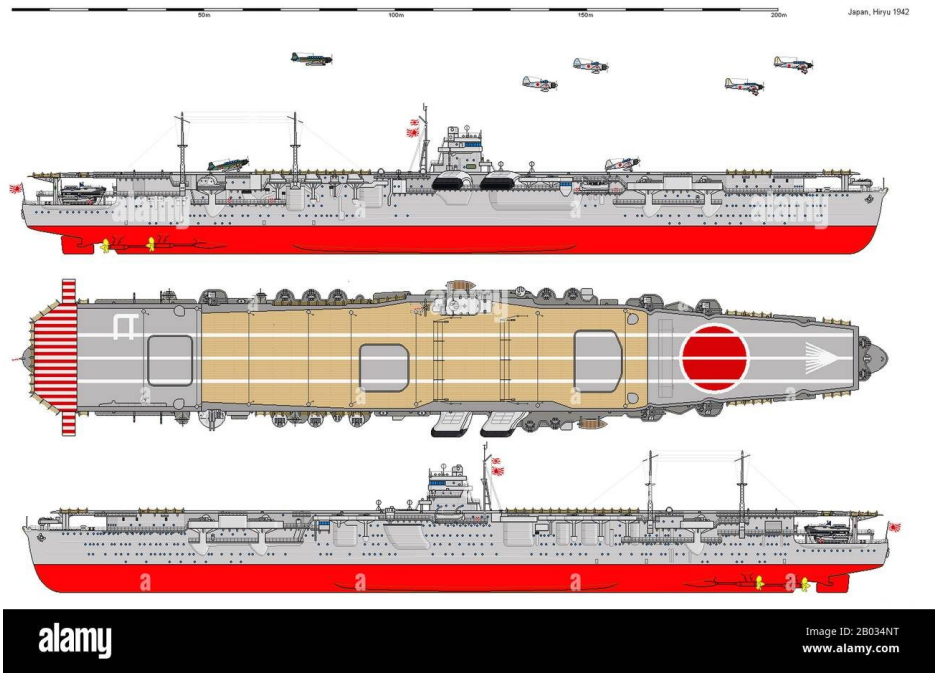


Large carrier, high aerial (likely Kaga; caption needed)

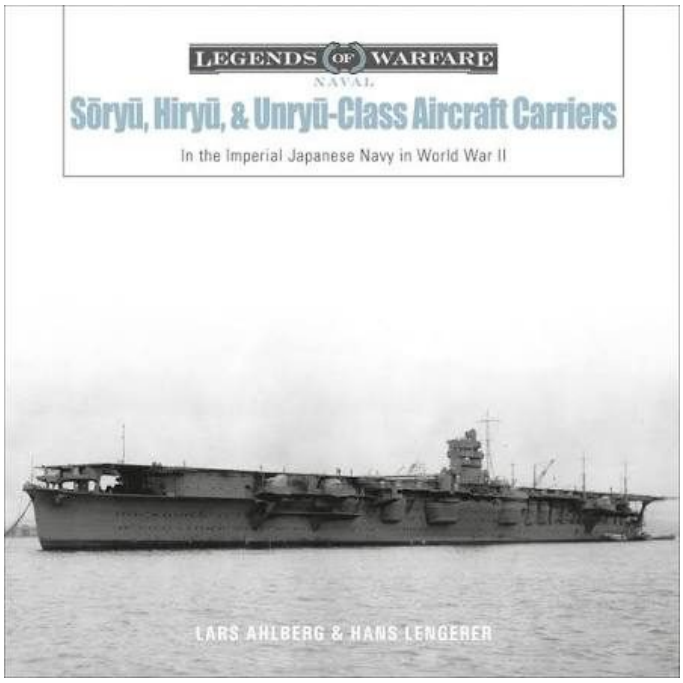
Soryu / Hiryu class (fleet carrier)

Draw from these: Hiryu: port island, two downturned starboard funnels, three elevators, striped stern round-down, katakana marking.

For 1941-45: Soryu has the island on the starboard side.



Hiryu plan and profiles, 1942

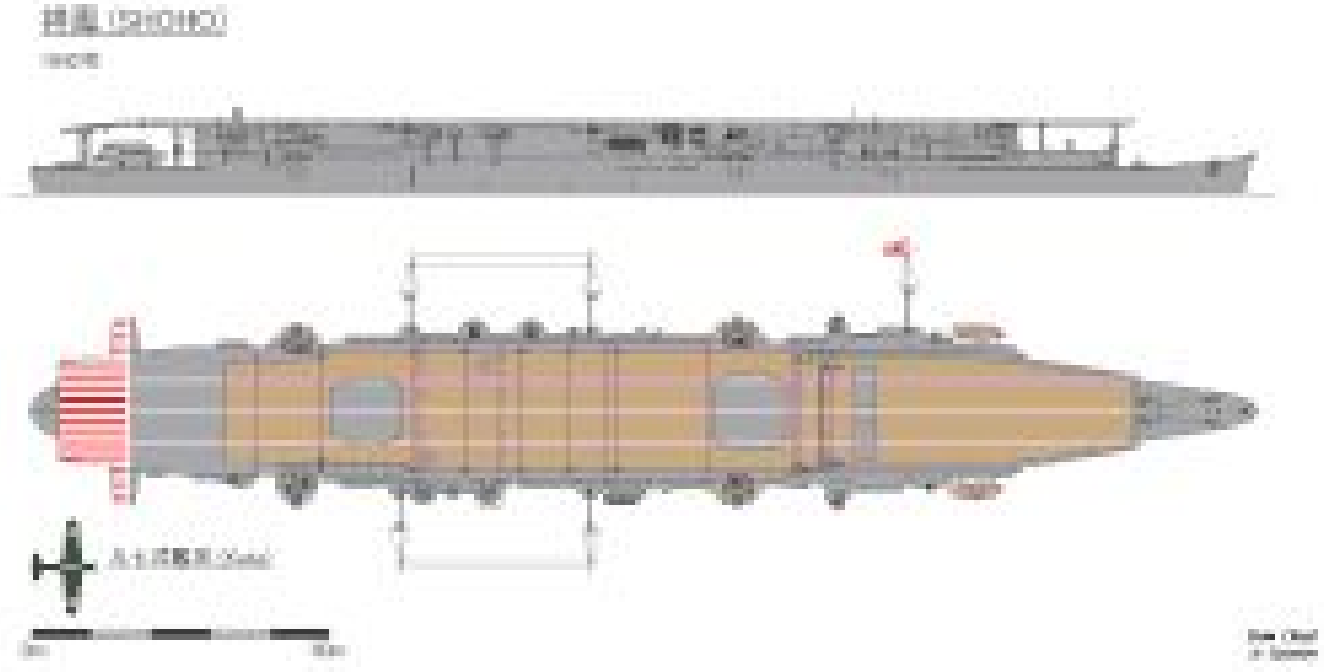


Book cover: Soryu, Hiryu and Unryu-class carriers

Zuiho class (light carrier)

Draw from these: Flush deck, no island, folding masts, downturned starboard funnel.

For 1941-45: No changes needed.



Shoho (sister ship) plan and profile

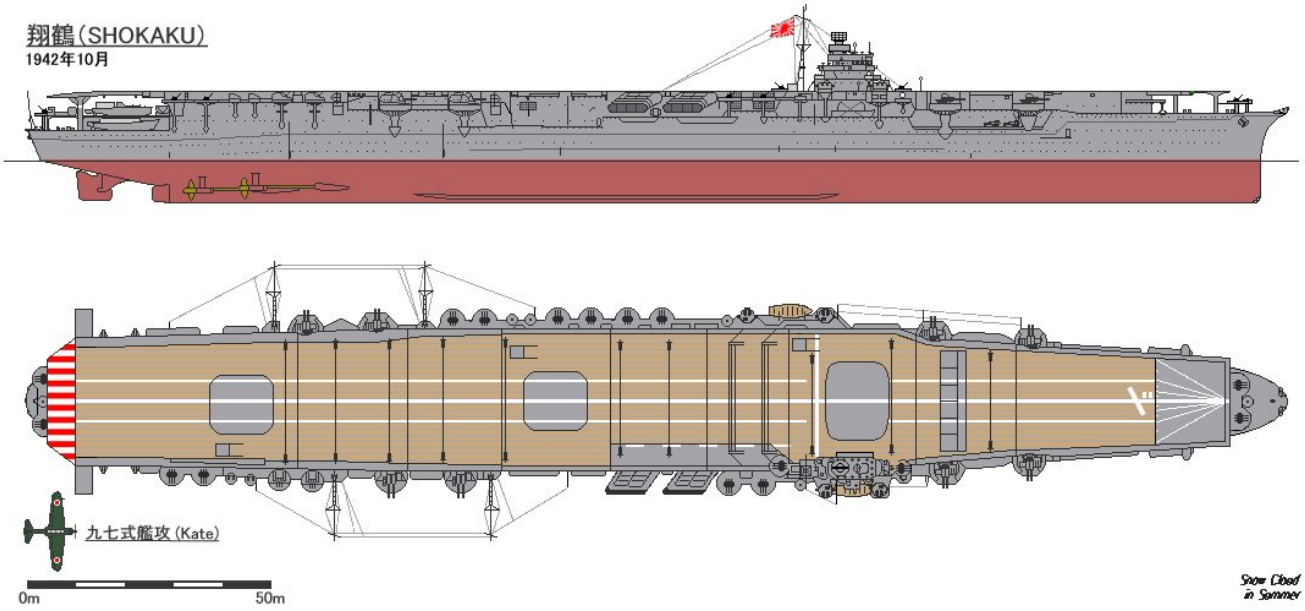


Zuiho at anchor, side view

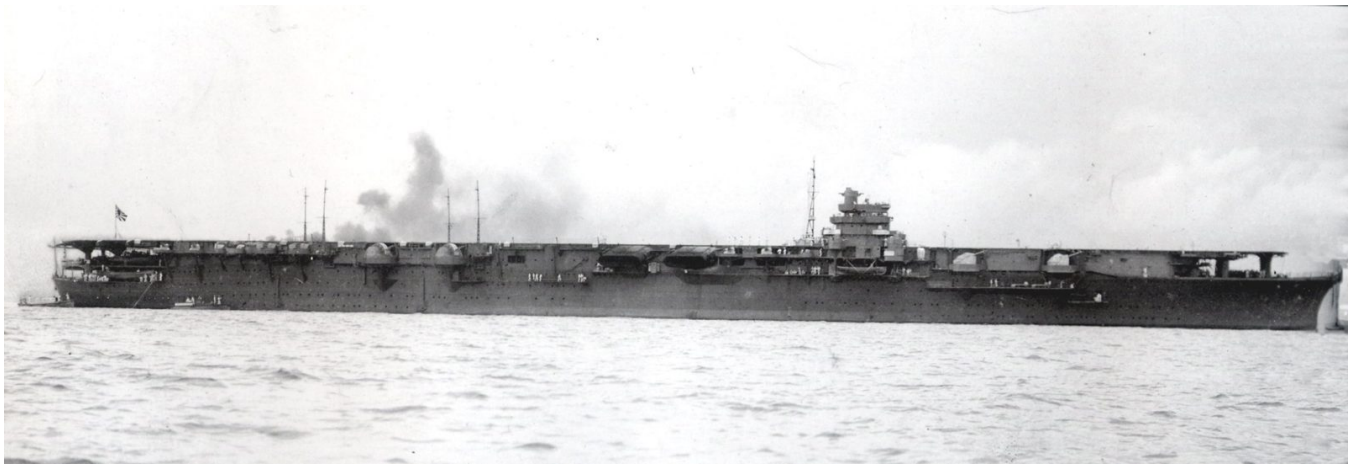
Shokaku class (fleet carrier), includes Zuikaku

Draw from these: Starboard island forward, three elevators, striped round-down, long rows of AA sponsons.

For 1941-45: No changes needed.



Shokaku plan and profile, October 1942



Shokaku at anchor, about 1941

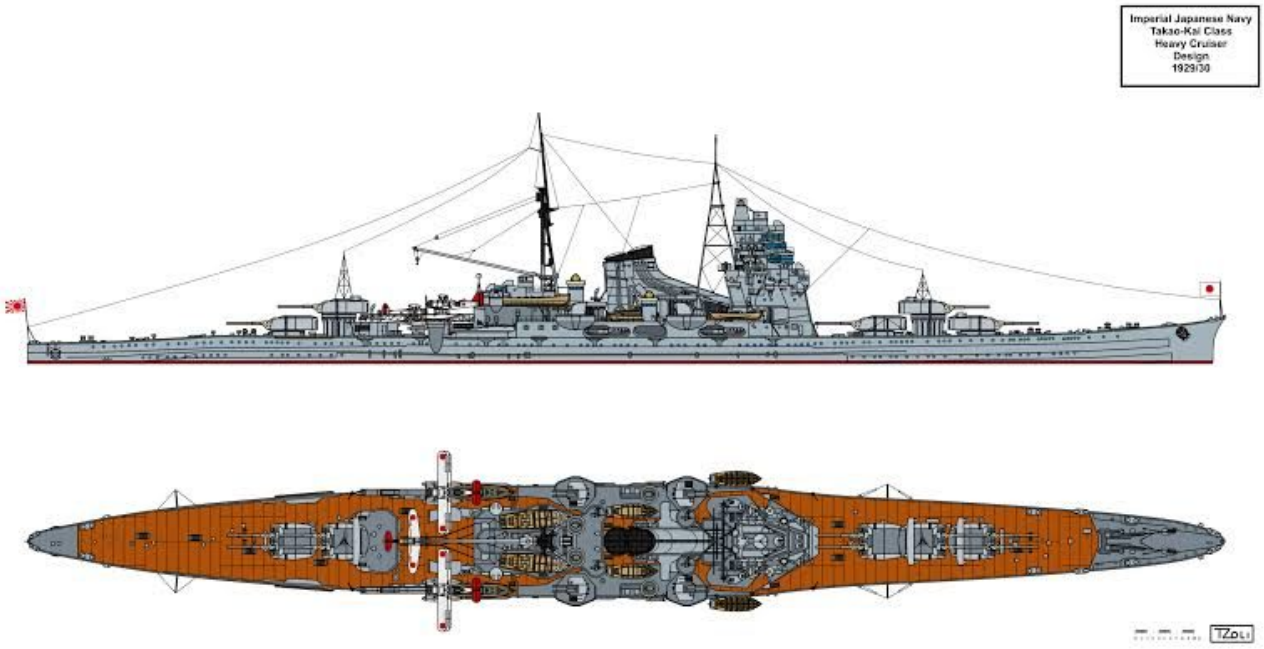
Takao class (heavy cruiser)

Draw from these: Castle-like bridge, three twin 20 cm turrets forward, linoleum decks.

For 1941-45: Turret layout from the photo, deck detail from the drawing.



Takao class at speed, colorized



Takao-Kai design drawing, 1929/30 (shows only two forward turrets)

Myoko class (heavy cruiser)

Draw from these: Three twin turrets forward, two funnels; late-war disruptive camouflage.

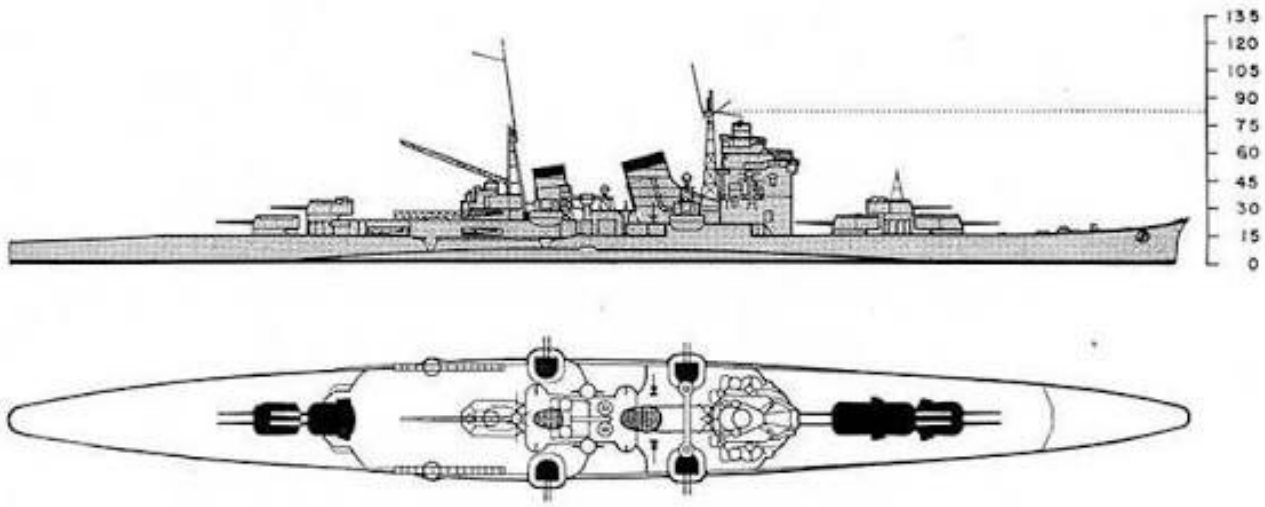
For 1941-45: Use the photos for turret count.



Myoko-class cruiser in late-war camouflage, likely Singapore 1945



Myoko class at speed, colorized

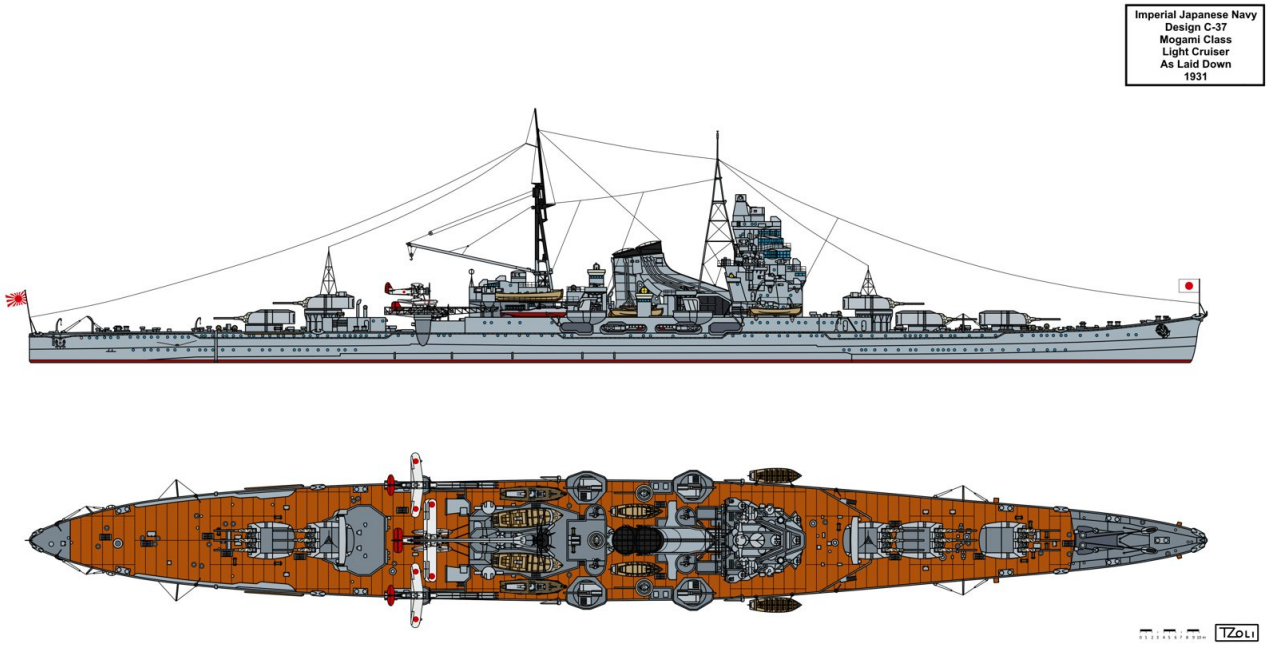


Line drawing (may not be Myoko; check turret count)

Mogami class (heavy cruiser)

Draw from these: Five turrets, trunked funnel, linoleum deck, catapults amidships.

For 1941-45: Twin 20.3 cm turrets from 1939. Mogami herself converted to an aircraft cruiser in 1943.



Mogami-class design C-37, as laid down 1931

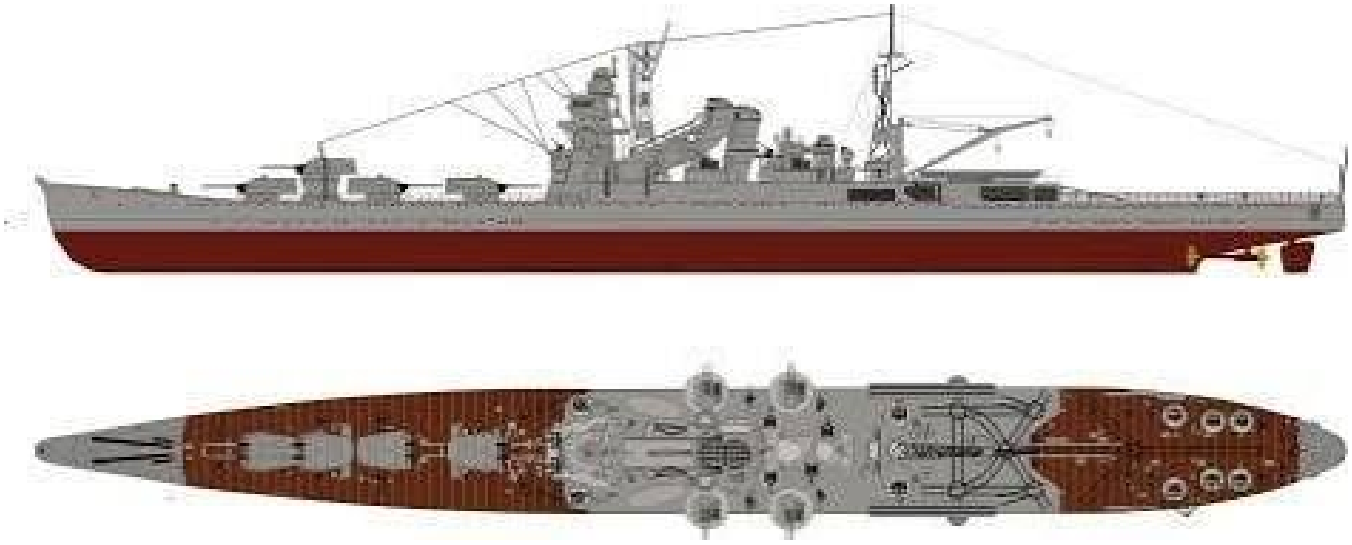


Mogami-class cruiser, mid-1930s, triple 15.5 cm turrets

Tone class (heavy cruiser)

Draw from these: All four twin turrets forward, seaplane deck aft with catapults and crane; Jake and Pete scout floatplanes.

For 1941-45: No changes needed.



Tone plan and profile



Tone-class cruiser with floatplanes aft

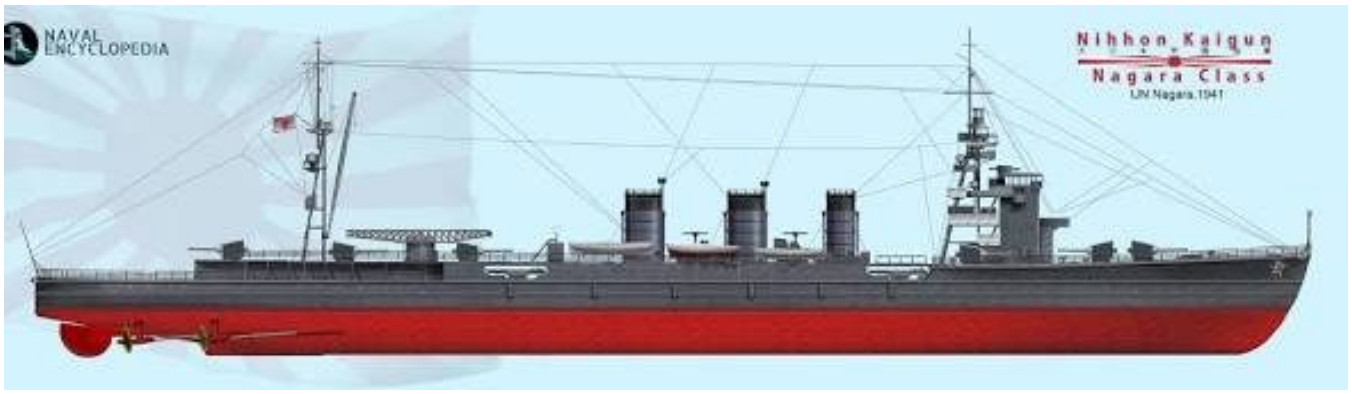
Nagara class (light cruiser)

Draw from these: Three funnels (Sendai class has four), single 14 cm guns, catapult, clipper bow.

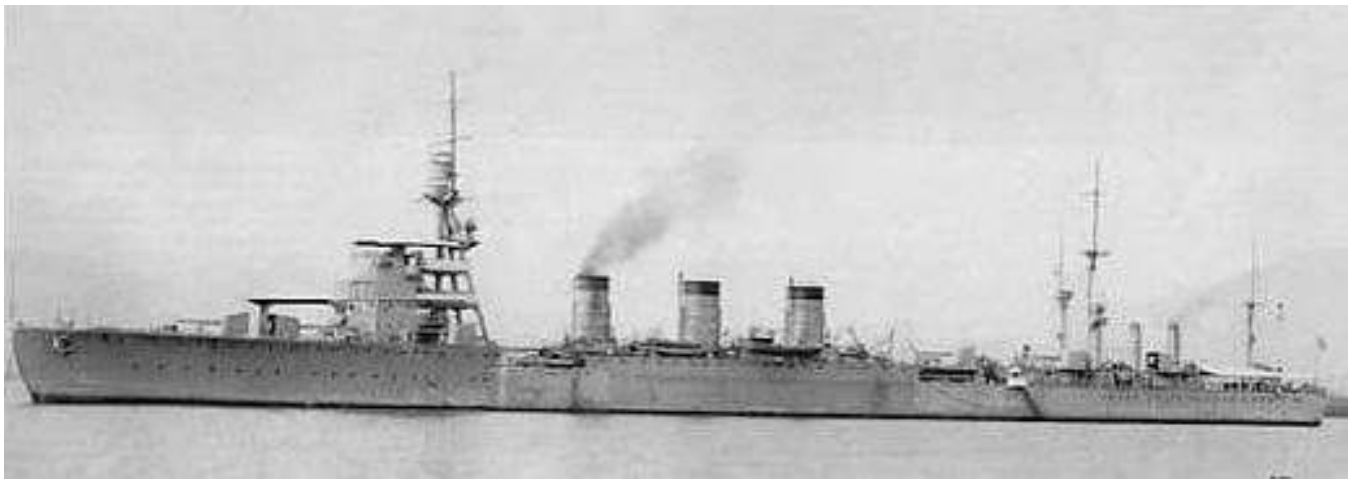
For 1941-45: No changes needed.



5,500-ton light cruiser at Shanghai, colorized



Nagara profile, 1941

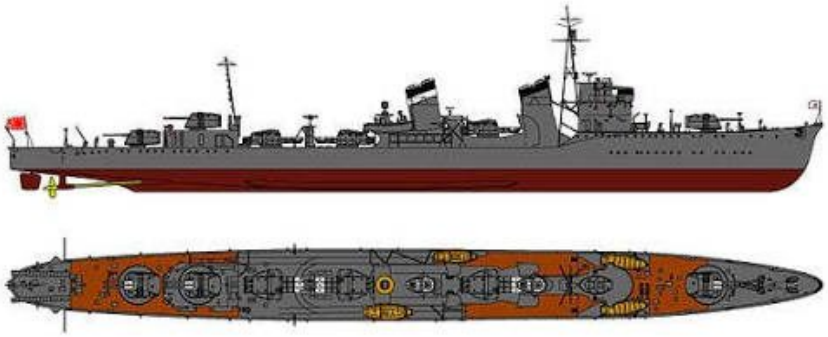


Nagara class, 1930s side view

Fubuki class (destroyer)

Draw from these: Three twin gunhouses, three triple torpedo mounts, two funnels.

For 1941-45: Remove hull numbers and funnel bands for wartime.



Fubuki class plan and profile



Fubuki class, hull number 20, prewar

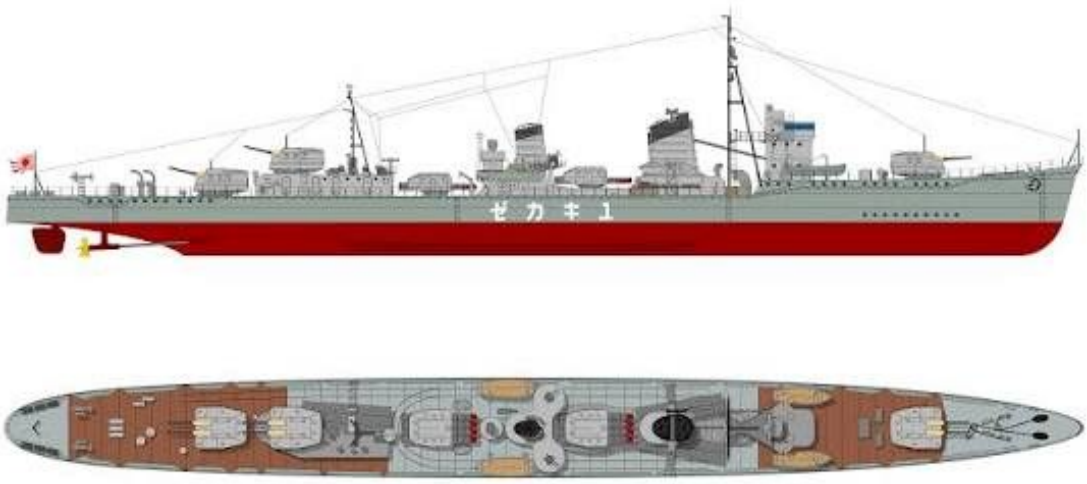


Painting of Miyuki (19)

Kagero class (destroyer)

Draw from these: Three twin gunhouses, two quadruple Long Lance torpedo mounts with reloads.

For 1941-45: Remove large hull names for wartime.



Yukikaze plan and profile

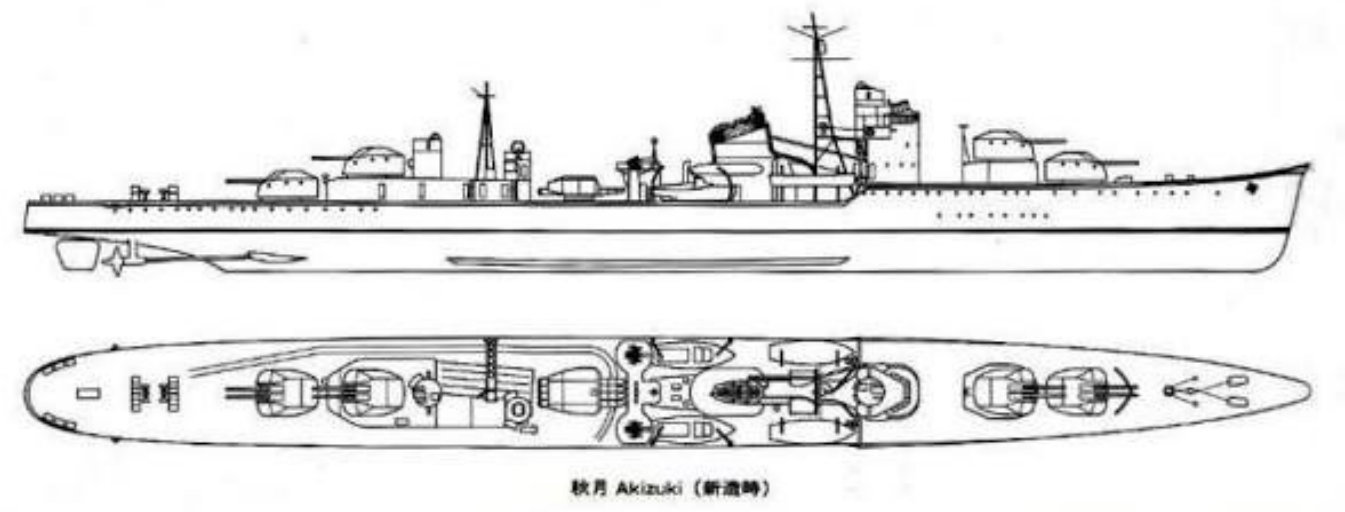


Yukikaze underway, about 1940

Akizuki class (destroyer)

Draw from these: Four twin 10 cm AA gunhouses, single large funnel, one quadruple torpedo mount.

For 1941-45: No changes needed.



Akizuki as completed, line drawing

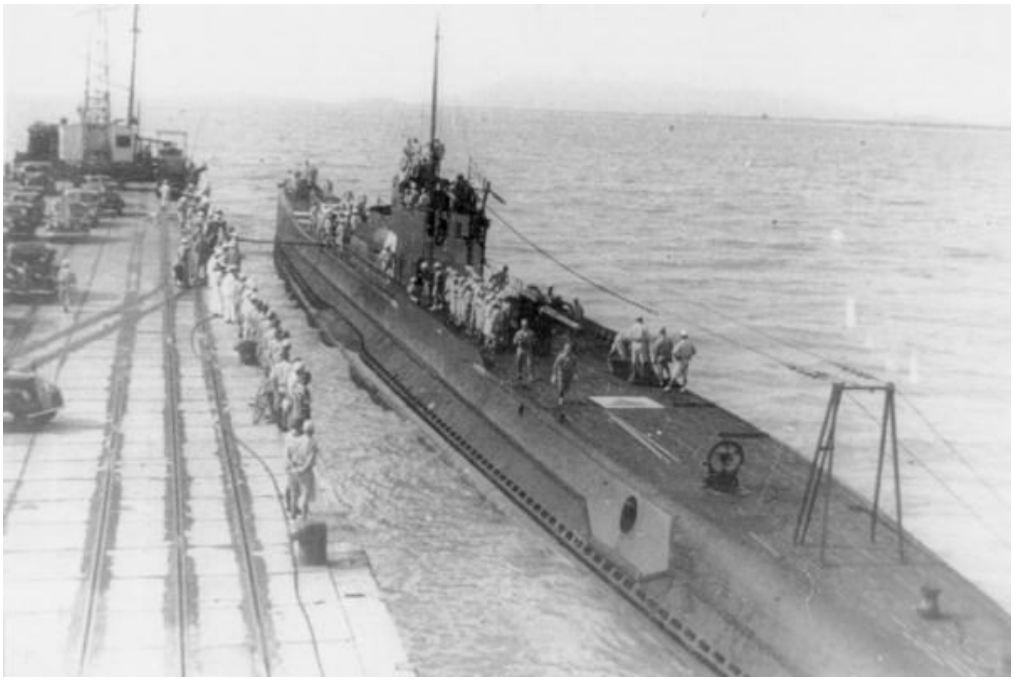


Akizuki on trials

I-boat (submarine)

Draw from these: Long wooden casing, hinomaru on the hull side, tall conning tower, sits low in the water.

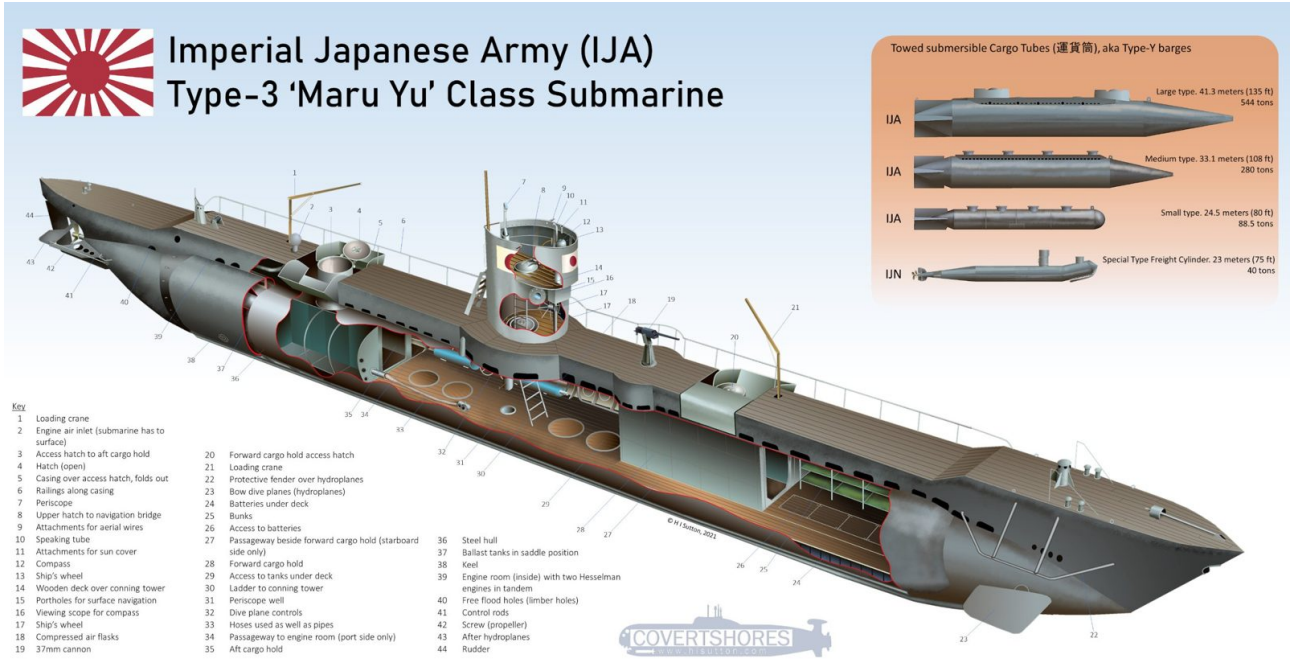
For 1941-45: No changes needed.



I-10 (Type A1) alongside a pier

Army supply submarine (target type)

Draw from these: Cargo submarine for island supply runs; a possible intercept target.



Imperial Japanese Army Type-3 Maru Yu cutaway (copyright H I Sutton, reference only)